Lesson 2

Salvation

Aim: To share the meaning of salvation.

Introduction: *Salvation is the greatest gift God has given to man; yet, many people, even some who claim to be Christians, are not even sure of their personal salvation from sin and hell. The Bible is very clear. God has given us eternal life through Jesus Christ.*

"Christ came to pay a debt he didn't owe because we owed a debt we couldn't pay."

2 Basic Greek Words

1. ***"Soteria"*** - translated 'salvation', Acts 4:12, Romans 1:16

2. ***"Sozo"*** - Another Greek word for salvation. *Its root meaning goes beyond just the forgiveness of sins.*

According to Strong's Concordance, *"Sozo"* also carries the idea of *being physically healed of diseases* and to *be delivered from your enemy*. In the spiritual sense, that enemy is the devil and his demons.

Salvation, then, must mean more than simply being saved to go to heaven when you die. *To be biblically saved means there are also earthly effects on our lives today*. Not only are you free from the judgment and wrath of God, this salvation *also includes the ability to resist temptations to sin in a pursuit of Christ-likeness, to be set free from demonic attacks and oppression*, and *to receive healing in our physical bodies*. These are listed among the many promises of God in the Scriptures.

For example,

"Bless the LORD, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits, <u>who forgives all your iniquity</u>, <u>who heals all your diseases</u>, <u>who redeems your life from the pit</u>, <u>who crowns you with</u> <u>steadfast love and mercy</u>…" (Psalm 103:2-4)

And *“But he was pierced for our transgressions; he was crushed for our iniquities; upon him was the chastisement that brought us peace, and with his wounds we are healed.” (Isaiah 53:5 ESV)*

“When Jesus came into Peter’s house, he saw Peter’s mother-in-law lying in bed with a fever. He touched her hand and the fever left her, and she got up and began to wait on him. When evening came, many who were demon-possessed were brought to him, and he drove out the spirits with a word and healed all the sick. This was to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet Isaiah:
“He took up our infirmities
and bore our diseases.” (Matthew 8:14-17)

I. WHY IS SALVATION IMPORTANT?

A. Because of the reality of Sin.

“For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God”. (Romans 3:23 NIV)

B. The penalty or wages of sin is death.

“For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.” (Romans 6:23 NIV)

“But the cowardly, the unbelieving, the vile, the murderers, the sexually immoral, those who practice magic arts, the idolaters and all liars—they will be consigned to the fiery lake of burning sulfur. This is the second death." (Revelation 21:8 NIV)

C. Therefore, the way to be saved from hell or eternal damnation is to receive eternal life.

“For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.” (Romans 6:23 NIV)

II. WHO IS THE WAY TO HEAVEN? WHO IS THE AUTHOR OF SALVATION?

A. There are many ideas about this.

B. But the Bible tells us there's ONLY ONE WAY – JESUS

Jesus answered, *"I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me. "(John 14:6 NIV) "Salvation is found in no-one else, for there is no other name under heaven given to men by which we must be saved." (Acts 4:12)*

III. HOW CAN WE RECEIVE SALVATION?

A. Realize that we are sinners. Romans 3:23

B. Repent from our sins. Mark 1:15

"The time has come," He said. "The kingdom of God is near. <u>Repent</u> and <u>believe</u> the good news!"

1.Confess – 1 John 1:9

"If we confess our sins (man's part), He is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and

purify us from all unrighteousness. (God's part)"

2.Forsake - John 5:14

"Later Jesus found him at the temple and said to him, "See, you are well again. Stop sinning or something worse may happen to you."

C. Recognize Christ as our Savior and Lord - Romans 10:9,10

"That if you confess with your mouth, "Jesus is Lord," and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved. For it is with your heart that you believe and are justified, and it is with your mouth that you confess and are saved. "

1 Peter 2:24

"He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, so that we might die to sins and live for righteousness; by his wounds you have been healed."

D. Receive or Accept Christ into your hearts

John 1:12

"Yet to all who received Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God."

E. Believe His word and promises that he will come to us when we receive Him.

Note: Salvation is a gift from God. Therefore, we receive it, by Faith.

Ephesians 2:8,9

"For it is <u>by grace</u> (favor, power, mercy) you have been saved, <u>through faith</u>-and this not from yourselves, it is the gift of God- not by works, so that no one can boast. "

IV. CONCLUSION/APPLICATION

Thank God that He has given us eternal life. Begin to walk a new life and seek to grow in Christ through prayer, worship, and fellowship.